

Enterprise Database Infrastructure Administration Lab

Design, Deployment, Security Hardening, Backup, Replication and
Monitoring of PostgreSQL Infrastructure on Linux

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PROJECT DESIGN & ARCHITECTURE

Enterprise Database Infrastructure Administration Lab

Design, Deployment, Security Hardening, Backup, Replication and Monitoring of PostgreSQL Infrastructure on Linux

Project Type : Enterprise Infrastructure Project

Environment : VMware Workstation Pro

Platform : Linux

Primary Database : PostgreSQL

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I. Introduction

1. Background

Modern organizations rely heavily on database systems to store, process, and secure critical business information. Database administrators and system administrators are responsible for ensuring that databases remain available, secure, performant, and recoverable in the event of failures.

As organizations increasingly adopt Linux-based infrastructures and open-source technologies, PostgreSQL has become one of the most widely used enterprise-grade relational database management systems due to its reliability, extensibility, security features, and high-performance capabilities.

This project aims to simulate a real-world enterprise database environment by designing, deploying, securing, monitoring, and maintaining a PostgreSQL infrastructure within a virtualized environment.

The project follows industry best practices and focuses on the operational responsibilities typically performed by System Administrators, Database Administrators (DBAs), Infrastructure Engineers, and DevOps professionals.

2. Problem Statement

Organizations face several challenges when managing databases :

- Unauthorized access attempts
- Data corruption or accidental deletion
- Service outages
- Storage failures
- Performance degradation
- Backup failures
- Replication issues
- Lack of monitoring and visibility

A properly designed database infrastructure must mitigate these risks while ensuring business continuity and data integrity.

3. Project Purpose

The purpose of this project is to build a fully functional enterprise database administration environment capable of supporting production-like operations while providing hands-on experience in :

- Database deployment
- Database administration
- Security hardening
- Backup and recovery
- Replication
- Monitoring
- Troubleshooting
- Automation

II. Project Objectives

1. General Objectives

Design and deploy a secure, resilient, monitored, and manageable PostgreSQL infrastructure in a VMware Workstation environment using Linux servers.

2. Specific Objectives

The project will enable the Following :

i. Infrastructure Administration

- Deploy multiple Linux servers
- Configure static network addressing
- Manage system services
- Configure remote administration

ii. Database Administration

- Install PostgreSQL
- Create databases
- Manage users and roles
- Configure authentication
- Manage schemas and privileges

iii. Security

- Harden Linux servers
- Secure database access
- Restrict network exposure
- Implement auditing and logging

iv. Data Protection

- Configure backups
- Implement recovery procedures
- Validate restoration processes

v. High Availability

- Deploy PostgreSQL replication
- Test synchronization
- Simulate failover scenarios

vi. Monitoring

- Monitor infrastructure health
- Monitor database performance
- Collect metrics
- Visualize dashboards

vii. Operations

- Troubleshoot incidents
- Analyze logs

III. Project Scope

1. Included

The project includes :

- i. Infrastructure**
 - Linux Server Deployment
 - Network Configuration
 - SSH Administration
- ii. PostgreSQL Administration**
 - Installation
 - Configuration
 - User Management
 - Security
 - Maintenance
- iii. Data Protection**
 - Backup
 - Restore
 - Recovery Testing
- iv. Replication**
 - Primary Server
 - Replica Server
 - Synchronization Verification
- v. Monitoring**
 - Server Monitoring
 - PostgreSQL Monitoring
 - Alerting
- vi. Automation**
 - Backup Automation
 - Maintenance Tasks
 - Scheduled Operations
- vii. Incident Response**
 - Failure Simulation
 - Troubleshooting
 - Service Recovery

2. Excluded

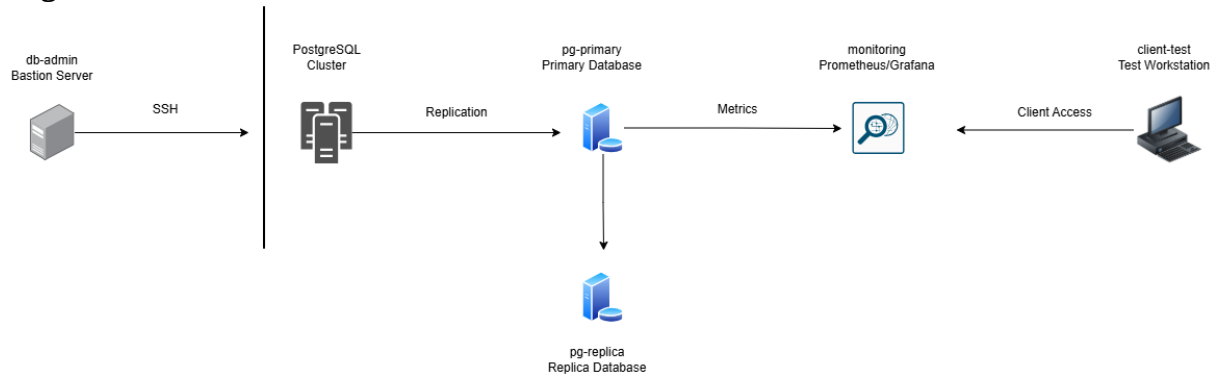
The following items are outside the scope of this project :

- Cloud Deployment
- Kubernetes Integration
- Multi-site Disaster Recovery
- Production Internet Exposure
- Application Development

These may be considered future enhancements.

IV. Project Architecture

High-Level Architecture



V. Virtual Machine Inventory

1. VM1 – Administration Server

Parameter	Value
Hostname	db-admin
OS	Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS
Role	Administration
vCPU	2
RAM	2 GB
Disk	20 GB

Responsibilities

- SSH Administration
- Maintenance Operations
- Script Execution
- Future Ansible Controller

2. VM2 – PostgreSQL Primary

Parameter	Value
Hostname	pg-primary
OS	Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS
Role	Production Database
vCPU	2
RAM	4 GB
Disk	40 GB

Responsibilities

- Main Database Server
- Transaction Processing
- Backup Source
- Replication Source

3. VM3 – PostgreSQL Replica

Parameter	Value
Hostname	pg-replica

OS	Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS
Role	Standby Database
vCPU	2
RAM	4 GB
Disk	40 GB

Responsibilities

- Replication Target
- Read Replica
- Failover Testing

4. VM4 - Monitoring Server

Parameter	Value
Hostname	monitoring
OS	Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS
Role	Monitoring & Backup
vCPU	2
RAM	4 GB
Disk	40 GB

Responsibilities

- Metrics Collection
- Dashboard Visualization
- Backup Storage
- Alerting

5. VM5 – Client Workstation

Parameter	Value
Hostname	client-test
OS	Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS
Role	Database Client
vCPU	1
RAM	2 GB
Disk	20 GB

Responsibilities

- Database Connectivity Testing
- Query Execution
- User Validation

VI. Network Design**1. Network Information**

Parameter	Value
Network Type	VMware Custom Network
Subnet	192.168.10.0/24
Gateway	192.168.10.2

DNS	8.8.8.8
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2. IP Addressing Plan

Hostname	IP Address
db-admin	192.168.10.10
pg-primary	192.168.10.20
pg-replica	192.168.10.21
monitoring	192.168.10.30
client-test	192.168.10.40

VII. Technology Stack

- **Operating System**
 - Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS
- **Database Platform**
 - PostgreSQL
- **Monitoring**
 - Prometheus
 - Grafana
- **Administration**
 - OpenSSH
 - Bash
 - Cron
- **Automation**
 - Bash Scripting
 - Ansible (future enhancement)

VIII. Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful if :

- PostgreSQL services operate normally.
- Remote administration functions correctly.
- Database replication is operational.
- Backups are successfully created and restored.
- Monitoring dashboards display real-time metrics.
- Security controls are implemented and validated.
- Incident simulations are completed successfully.
- Complete technical documentation is produced.